

Thursday, 11 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Rain 16° 11°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 17° 11°	MANCHESTER Light rain 15° 11°	GLASGOW Rain 14° 10°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Disorder has continued in Belfast following a knife attack earlier this week, with houses across the city being set on fire.

Police and firefighters have been helping families leave their homes amid the unrest. A terror adviser has described the situation as 'destabilising'.

CRIME · UK
- 2

Three people have been arrested in Glasgow over disorder and racist assaults, following the knife attack in Belfast.

Police Scotland confirmed members of the public were attacked 'because of the colour of their skin' on Tuesday evening. Protests have also taken place across Scotland.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Two migrants have been jailed under new small boats legislation, after being found piloting vessels across the Channel.

A Sudanese national and an Afghan national both received prison sentences. This marks a significant moment for the new law.

MIGRATION · UK
- 4

A convicted rapist who was mistakenly released from prison has fled the UK on a Eurostar train.

Bernadin Dedic is now on the run from justice after being set free from HMP Wormwood Scrubs. A manhunt is underway.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Personal data belonging to students has been accessed in a major cyber-attack targeting a UK university.

Hackers from a well-known criminal group are behind the breach. The university has confirmed that student information was compromised.

CYBER SECURITY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The first contestant for the new series of Strictly Come Dancing has been announced, and it's a familiar face from Albert Square!**
Lacey Turner, best known for playing Stacey Slater in EastEnders, will be hitting the dancefloor. She joined the soap back in 2004.
ON AIR – Who do you think Lacey's professional partner should be? And who else would you love to see on Strictly this year?
TV · COMING UP
- 2 Rock and metal fans are gearing up for the UK's biggest festival of its kind, as Download Festival kicks off this weekend.**
Donington Park is once again hosting the legendary event. Expect a packed lineup of bands and plenty of energy.
ON AIR – Are you heading to Download this year? Or what's your favourite rock festival memory?
MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 3 Chelsea forwards Cole Palmer and Joao Pedro have made a surprise appearance in a promotional film for Madonna's new album.**
It's an unexpected crossover between pop royalty and football stars. Fans are loving the collaboration.
ON AIR – What's the most surprising celebrity cameo you've ever seen in a music video?
MUSIC · COMING UP
- 4 Legendary director Steven Spielberg believes we could discover alien life within our lifetimes.**
His latest film explores what might happen if non-human intelligence was revealed to the world. It's certainly a fascinating thought.
ON AIR – Do you think we'll discover aliens in our lifetime? And if so, how do you think humanity would react?
FILM · COMING UP
- 5 Swifties worldwide are buzzing with speculation and rumours about the potential wedding date for Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce.**
Fans are meticulously looking for clues about the superstar's nuptials to the American football star. The internet is awash with theories!
ON AIR – Are you a 'Swiftie' trying to decode the clues? And what's the most elaborate wedding rumour you've ever heard?
MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Ben Stokes will miss England's second Test against New Zealand at The Oval after an incident in a London nightclub.**

Joe Root will step up as interim captain for the match. This is a significant blow for the England team.

ON AIR – How do you think Stokes' absence will affect England's chances against New Zealand? And is it right for Root to step in?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Everton have been ordered to pay Burnley £35m due to breaches of the Premier League's financial rules.**

This ruling highlights the ongoing scrutiny of club finances in English football. It's a hefty sum for the Toffees.

ON AIR – Do you think these financial penalties are enough to deter clubs from breaching rules? Or should the punishments be even stricter?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **British boxer Chantelle Cameron is set to face American Mikaela Mayer in a light-middleweight world title unification bout.**

The highly anticipated fight will take place in Birmingham on August 29th. It promises to be a thrilling encounter.

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to this unification bout? Who do you think will come out on top?

BOXING · UK

4 **Serena Williams has made a triumphant return to professional tennis at the Queen's Club, securing a first-round doubles victory.**

The 44-year-old American icon inspired her partner Victoria Mboko on the Andy Murray Arena. It's a remarkable comeback.

ON AIR – How incredible is it to see Serena Williams still competing at the highest level? What's your favourite Serena memory?

TENNIS · UK

5 **Two-time Women's Rugby World Cup winner Marlie Packer has agreed to join Harlequins for next season.**

She will be leaving Saracens to make the move. Harlequins described her as a 'perfect fit' for the club.

ON AIR – How big a signing is Marlie Packer for Harlequins? And what impact do you think she'll have?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 British gardeners are finding joy in 'miniature gardening', creating tiny landscapes in pots and terrariums.**
It's a delightful way to bring the outdoors in, perfect for small spaces and a charming hobby for all ages.
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'porch parcels' is gaining popularity, where neighbours leave small gifts or treats for each other.**
It's a lovely, low-key way to build community spirit and spread a little unexpected happiness.
- 3 More people are discovering the relaxing art of 'pebble painting', decorating stones to leave in public places for others to find.**
It's a creative outlet that brings a smile to both the artist and the lucky person who stumbles upon a colourful creation.
- 4 A new trend sees friends and families swapping 'recipe boxes', sharing their favourite home-cooked meals ready for reheating.**
It's a fantastic way to enjoy different cuisines without the fuss of cooking from scratch, and a lovely gesture of friendship.
- 5 The humble 'bird feeder' is being re-imagined as a decorative garden feature, with intricate and artistic designs.**
These aren't just for the birds anymore; they're becoming stunning focal points that add charm to any outdoor space.
- 6 Many Brits are taking up 'upcycled crafting', transforming old items into new and useful household decorations.**
It's a sustainable hobby that sparks creativity, giving new life to forgotten objects and reducing waste.
- 7 The soothing practice of 'forest bathing', or Shinrin-yoku, is becoming a popular way to de-stress in nature.**
It involves mindfully immersing oneself in the atmosphere of the forest, focusing on the sights, sounds, and smells to relax and recharge.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'tidying up' *what* in our local supermarket aisle?

ANSWER: THE WONKY STACK OF TINS OR PACKETS THAT JUST DON'T LOOK RIGHT!

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday sound instantly makes them feel peaceful. What came out on top?

ANSWER: THE GENTLE PATTERN OF RAIN ON THE WINDOWPANE.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a specific smell can just instantly make you feel incredibly calm and happy?**
Is there a particular scent – maybe freshly baked bread, cut grass, or even a certain perfume – that just instantly puts a smile on your face and makes you feel wonderful?
- **We all have those little 'rituals' we do, don't we? Things we do every day, almost without thinking, that just make life feel right.**
Do you have a specific morning routine, a way you always make your tea, or a little habit before bed that you just can't skip? What are your comforting daily rituals?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** During World War II, carrots were promoted by the British government as helping pilots see in the dark, as a way to disguise the true reason for their improved night vision: radar technology.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The very first traffic light system was invented in London in 1868 and used gas lamps, but it was unfortunately short-lived after one of the lamps exploded.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- Strawberries are the only fruit that wear their seeds on the outside.
- The world's largest desert is not hot; it's the Antarctic Polar Desert, which covers most of the continent.
- Before erasers were invented, people used breadcrumbs to rub out pencil marks.
- The original name for the butterfly was 'flutterby'.

On this day

Day 162 of the year, 203 days left in 2026. Today Brazilian Navy Day (Brazil); Christian feast day: Alice of Schaerbeek; Christian feast day: Barnabas the Apostle; Christian feast day: Bartholomew the Apostle (Eastern Christianity). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Andy Lee, Irish boxer
- 1978 — Joshua Jackson, Canadian-American actor
- 1964 — Penny Ford, American singer
- 1997 — Kodak Black, American rapper
- 1939 — Rachael Heyhoe Flint, Baroness Heyhoe Flint, English cricketer and journalist (died 2017)
- 1937 — Chad Everett, American actor and director (died 2012)
- 1997 — Jorja Smith, English singer
- 2001 — Billy Gilmour, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1978 — Altaf Hussain founds the student political movement All Pakistan Muhajir Students Organisation (APMSO) in Karachi University.
- 2013 — Greece's public broadcaster ERT is shut down by then-prime minister Antonis Samaras. It would be opened exactly two years later by then-prime minister Alexis Tsipras.
- 1971 — The U.S. Government forcibly removes the last holdouts to the Native American Occupation of Alcatraz, ending 19 months of control.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1962 — Frank Morris, John Anglin and Clarence Anglin allegedly become the only prisoners to escape from the prison on Alcatraz Island.
- 2007 — Mudslides in Chittagong, Bangladesh, kill 130 people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1963 — American Civil Rights Movement: Governor of Alabama George Wallace defiantly stands at the door of Foster Auditorium at the University of Alabama in an attempt to block two black students, Vivian Malone and James Hood, from attending that school. Later in the day, accompanied...

- 1971 — The U.S. Government forcibly removes the last holdouts to the Native American Occupation of Alcatraz, ending 19 months of control.
- 1944 — USS Missouri, the last battleship built by the United States Navy and future site of the signing of the Japanese Instrument of Surrender, is commissioned.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 163 of the year, 202 days left in 2026. Today Chaco Armistice Day (Paraguay); Christian feast day: 108 Martyrs of World War II; Christian feast day: Basilides; Christian feast day: Blessed Hildegard Burjan. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1978 — Lewis Moody, English rugby player
- 1990 — David Worrall, English footballer
- 1951 — Brad Delp, American musician and singer (died 2007)
- 1992 — Allie DiMeco, American actress and musician
- 1949 — John Wetton, English singer-songwriter, bass player, and producer (died 2017)
- 1952 — Junior Brown, American country music singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1956 — Michael Angelo Batio, American heavy metal guitarist
- 1934 — Kevin Billington, English director and producer (died 2021)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1988 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 046, a McDonnell Douglas MD-81, crashes short of the runway at Libertador General José de San Martín Airport, killing all 22 people on board.
- 1999 — Kosovo War: Operation Joint Guardian begins when a NATO-led United Nations peacekeeping force, Kosovo Force (KFor), enters the province of Kosovo in the Federal Republic of Yugoslavia.
- 1954 — Pope Pius XII canonises Dominic Savio, who was 14 years old at the time of his death, as a saint, making him at the time the youngest unmartyred saint in the Roman Catholic Church. In 2017, Francisco and Jacinta Marto, aged ten and nine at the time of their deaths, are declare...

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1987 — The Central African Republic's former emperor Jean-Bédel Bokassa is sentenced to death for crimes he had committed during his 13-year rule.
- 1988 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 046, a McDonnell Douglas MD-81, crashes short of the runway at Libertador General José de San Martín Airport, killing all 22 people on board.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)